

Three places a Treebo booking breaks, and who can fix each

I read every 1★–2★ Play Store review since January 2025 that describes what happened, 125 in all. **29 describe a stay that didn't match the booking.** They fall into three different breaks, each with a different owner, so one fix won't cover them.

01 Where the booking breaks

● IN THE APP

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What was saved isn't what the guest chose

- Guest count saved lower than selected (4)
- Dates moved when booking after midnight (2)
- Price changed after payment (2)
- Payment asked again after paying in full (1)

Owner: app and payments

● BETWEEN APP AND HOTEL

15

The hotel can't or won't give what was sold

- Breakfast paid for, not served (8)
- Hotel full, cancelled or moved the booking (6)
- Paid-for view not there (1)

Owner: hotel supply and partner product

● AT THE DESK

5

App guests treated differently

- "Rooms for offline bookings only" or worse rooms for app guests (3)
- ID refused (1)
- Extra charges "in the name of rules" (1)

Owner: partner operations

11 of 29 also say support couldn't help in time: a WhatsApp bot, calls on hold, no reply for days.

4 learned on the day that the hotel couldn't take them, two while travelling with family.

02 What stands out

- **The first break is a software problem, and the cheapest to fix.** The same guest-count complaint appears four times across six months.
- **The second is a contract problem.** The app sells something the hotel hasn't agreed to give at that moment. With partner-owned hotels, the hotel needs to confirm what was sold, not just receive a booking.
- **The third is about incentives.** If a desk earns more from walk-in guests, it may have a reason to give app guests less. Clear rules and per-hotel tracking change that.

"I had selected for 3 guests (2adult & 1child) and then i booked it's showing only 2 guests."

1★ · 19 Apr 2026

"Hotel staff denied serving breakfast stating the website is not upated properly."

1★ · 21 Mar 2026

"Within 10 minutes, while en route with my family, the hotel called saying all rooms were full."

1★ · 30 May 2026

"They said we've those rooms for offline bookings only and not for online bookings."

1★ · 1 Sep 2026

Make the booking the promise the hotel keeps

Fix the app

WEEKS • APP TEAM

- Before paying, repeat guests, dates, meals and total in large text: “Is this right?”
- After midnight, ask “Checking in tonight, 12 Oct?” instead of moving the date.
- Lock the price once payment starts; any change is shown before charging, never after.
- An automatic check that the saved booking equals what was selected, with an alert when it doesn’t.

Make the hotel confirm what was sold

PILOT • PARTNER PRODUCT

- The hotel confirms guests, meals and room type in its app within 15 minutes of booking.
- If it declines or doesn’t answer, the guest is offered a nearby Treebo at the same price, before travelling.
- Breakfast becomes a line item the hotel acknowledges; if it isn’t served, that amount is refunded without a support chat.

Protect app guests at the desk

PILOT • PARTNER OPS

- House rules (local ID, couples, early check-in cost) shown as clear chips before payment.
- A booking card the desk can check, with a “Not as booked” button that gets a call back within 15 minutes.
- The room type sold on the app is guaranteed at the desk; repeat reports pause sales for that hotel.

03 How I’d measure it

PRIMARY

“Not as booked” reports per 1,000 check-ins, by hotel, every week

ALSO TRACK

Share of bookings the hotel confirms within 15 min • hotel cancellations within 48 h of arrival • days to refund an unserved add-on

GUARDRAILS

Payment conversion doesn’t fall from the extra check • hotels don’t cancel more once they must confirm • partner hotels don’t leave over the extra step

ROLLOUT

App fixes for everyone right away. Hotel confirmation and desk card as a 6-week pilot in one city, compared with similar hotels elsewhere.

04 What I can’t see from outside

How bookings reach hotels today, what the hotel-side app already does, and whether hotel cancellations and unserved add-ons are tracked. The 15-minute and 48-hour figures are starting points to tune. Some of this may already exist; I’d check these first.